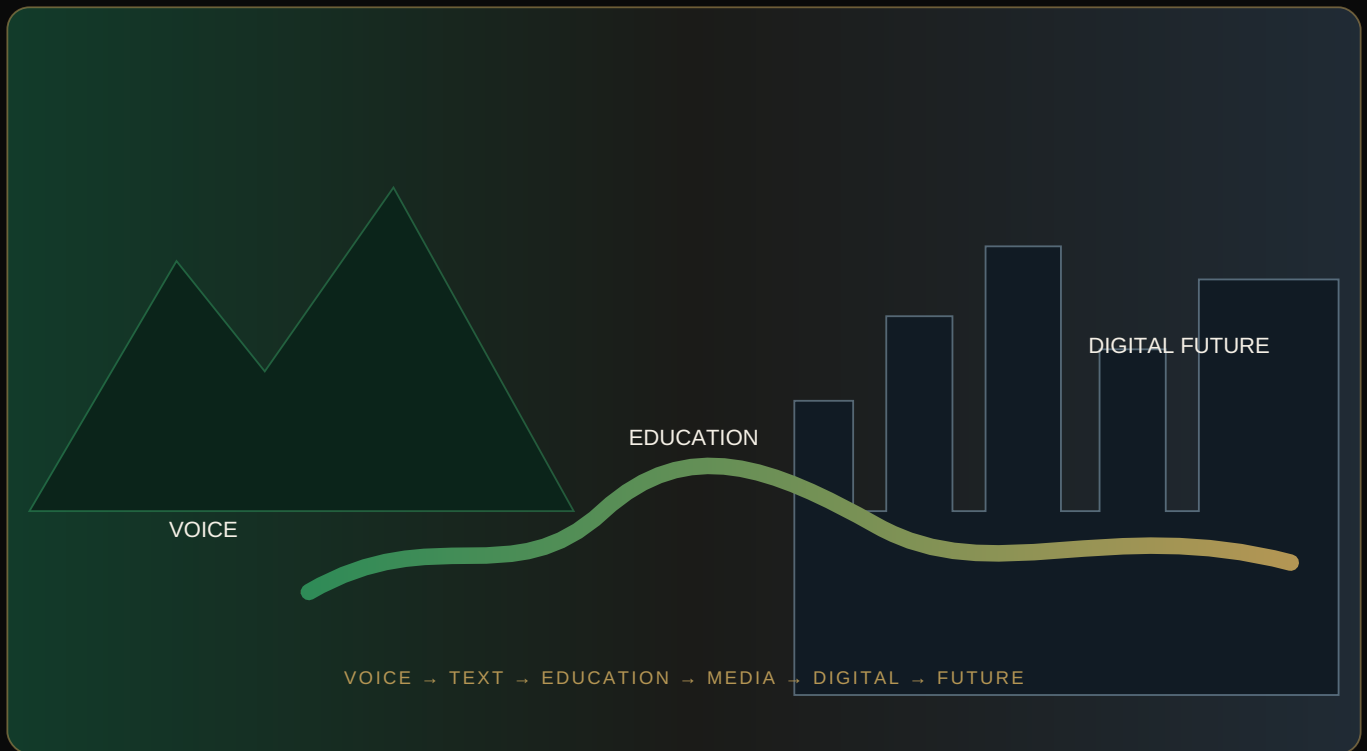


THE FUTURE OF PASHTO

“A living language needs a future in which it can be spoken, written, taught, created and understood.”



The Future of Pashto: A living language connecting ancestral roots to a digital world.

“A language does not survive because it belongs to the past.

It survives because people continue to use it. They speak it at home. They teach it to children. They write it. They sing it. They tell stories in it. They argue, joke, pray, work and dream in it.

Pashto has carried generations of memory across mountains, settlements, cities and borders. Its future, however, will not be decided by history alone. It will be shaped by schools, families, literature, media, migration, technology and the choices of young people.

The question is therefore not simply whether Pashto has a past. It does. The more important question is whether Pashto will remain fully usable in the future worlds its speakers are entering.”

WHAT IS PASHTO?

Pashto is an Eastern Iranian language of the Indo-Iranian branch of the Indo-European language family. It is spoken by millions primarily in Afghanistan (where it is a national language) and Pakistan (where it is a major regional language in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and northern Balochistan), as well as by significant diaspora communities worldwide. While it shares a common identity, Pashto contains significant dialect diversity across its geographic range.

PASHTO AND ORAKZAI

Pashto is the central medium of Orakzai cultural expression, connecting to the proverbs (Page 63), music (Page 61), and oral traditions (Page 65) discussed throughout this book. While Orakzai speakers participate in the broader Pashto linguistic world, local variations in pronunciation and vocabulary reflect the district's specific history and landscape.

FAMILY AND TRANSMISSION

Intergenerational transmission within the family is the primary site of language vitality. Research indicates that while Pashto remains the preferred home language for many, urban environments and migration (Pages 89, 90, 99) introduce multilingual hybridity, where Urdu and English are used for social mobility and education while Pashto maintains its role in home and community identity.

PASHTO IN EDUCATION

Language policy and education are critical to the future of literacy. Mother-tongue education provides a stronger cognitive foundation for early learning, yet its implementation varies across borders. In Pakistan, Pashto is taught as a subject in KP schools, while in Afghanistan, its status as an official language grants it a broader role in formal instruction.

DIGITAL PASHTO: UNICODE AND BEYOND

For a language to survive in the modern world, it must be digitally accessible. This requires standard Unicode encoding, reliable fonts, and functional keyboards across all devices. Pashto is currently classified in computational linguistics as a "low-resource" language,

meaning it lacks the massive datasets available for languages like English, but recent research in NLP (Natural Language Processing) is closing this gap.

AI AND THE LINGUISTIC FUTURE

Artificial Intelligence offers transformative possibilities for Pashto, including speech recognition, machine translation, and OCR (Optical Character Recognition). However, AI is a tool, not a source of authenticity. Human review is essential to ensure that AI-generated content does not fabricate history or erase linguistic nuance.

LINGUISTIC CLAIM MATRIX

Claim	Language Scope	Evidence	Source	Confidence
Home Dominance	Pashto	Urban Pakistan Study	Khalid (2026)	High
Low-Resource Status	Pashto	NLP Benchmarks	Haq (2023)	High
Multilingual Hybridity	Pashto/Urdu/English	Sociolinguistic Research	Nature (2026)	High
Digital Archiving Need	Pashto	UNESCO Framework	UNESCO (2021)	High

FUTURE SCENARIOS

1. Continuity

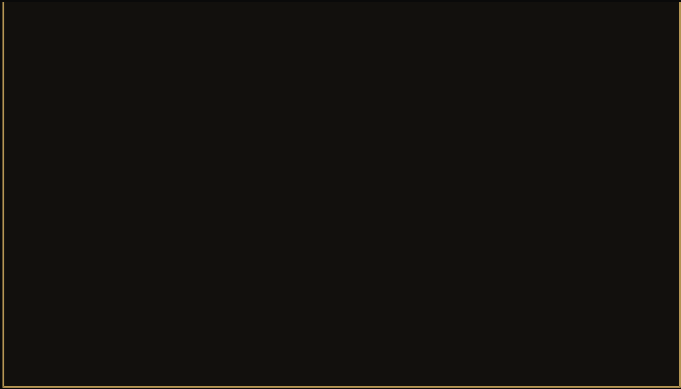
Strong intergenerational transmission; Pashto remains the dominant home and community language.

2. Adaptation

Pashto remains strong but becomes increasingly multilingual and digitally hybrid.

3. Fragmentation

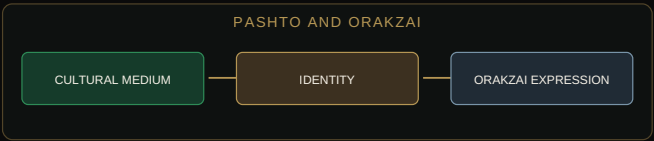
Domains shift toward other languages; Pashto remains concentrated in specific social settings.



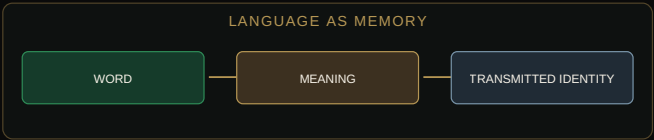
LOGIC ATLAS: THE FUTURE OF PASHTO



1. What is Pashto? — linguistic framework.



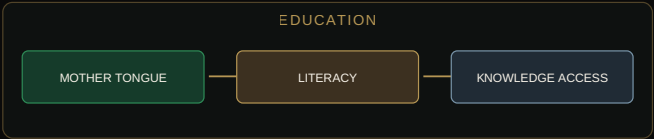
2. Pashto and Orakzai — linguistic framework.



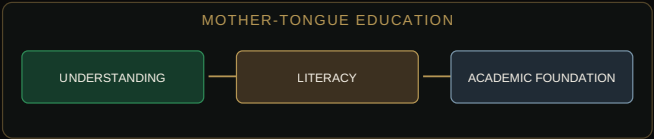
3. Language as memory — linguistic framework.



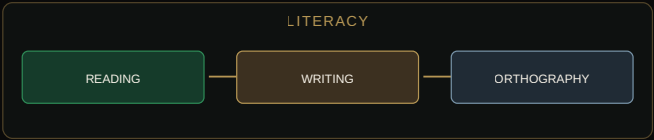
4. Family transmission — linguistic framework.



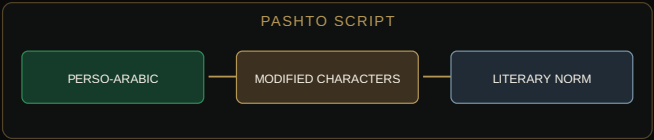
5. Education — linguistic framework.



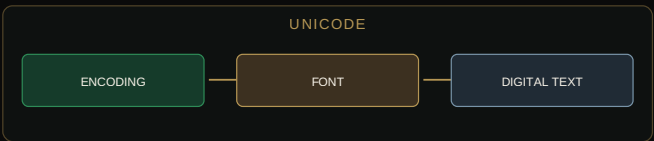
6. Mother-tongue education — linguistic framework.



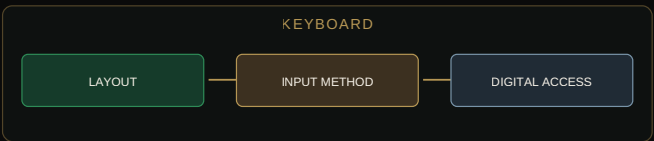
7. Literacy — linguistic framework.



8. Pashto script — linguistic framework.



9. Unicode — linguistic framework.



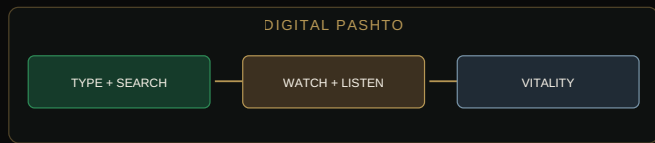
10. Keyboard — linguistic framework.



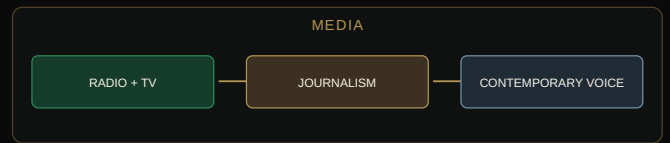
11. Pashto web — linguistic framework.



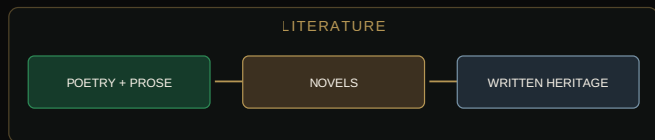
12. Social media — linguistic framework.



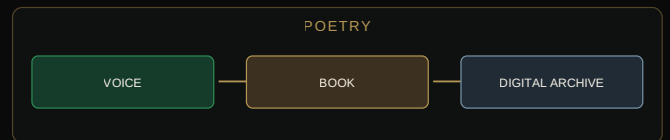
13. Digital Pashto — linguistic framework.



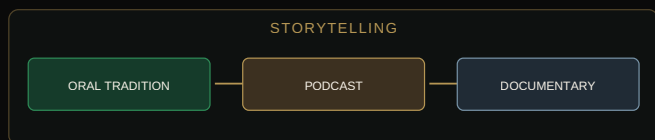
14. Media — linguistic framework.



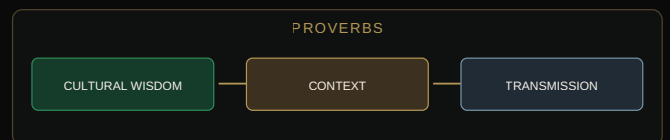
15. Literature — linguistic framework.



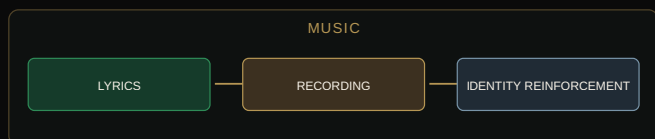
16. Poetry — linguistic framework.



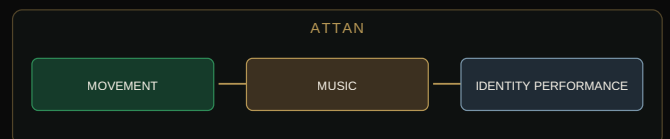
17. Storytelling — linguistic framework.



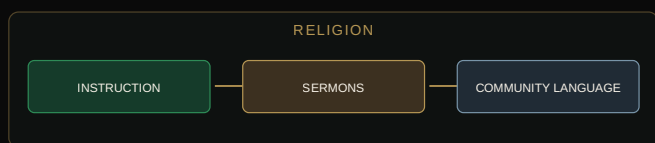
18. Proverbs — linguistic framework.



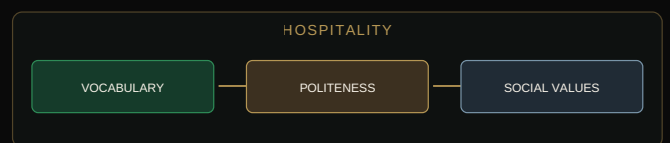
19. Music — linguistic framework.



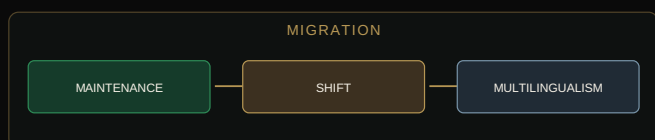
20. Attan — linguistic framework.



21. Religion — linguistic framework.



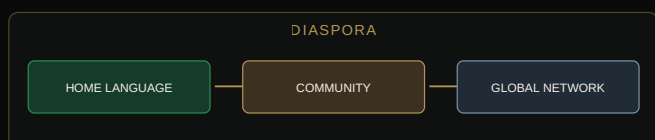
22. Hospitality — linguistic framework.



23. Migration — linguistic framework.



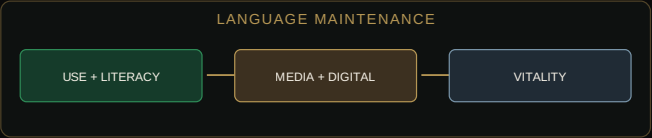
24. Cities — linguistic framework.



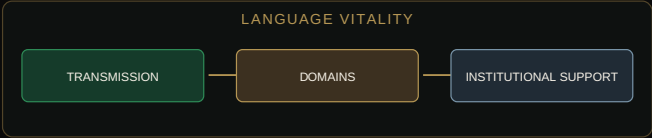
25. Diaspora — linguistic framework.



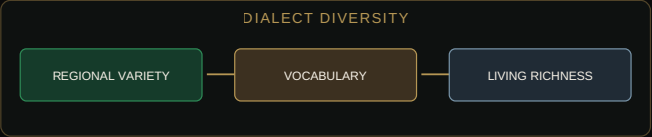
26. Language shift — linguistic framework.



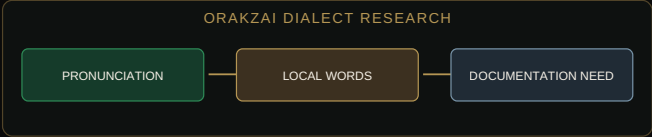
27. Language maintenance — linguistic framework.



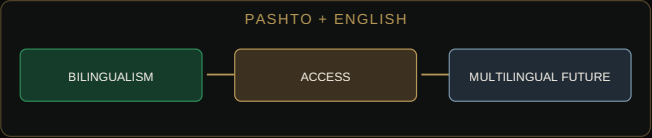
28. Language vitality — linguistic framework.



29. Dialect diversity — linguistic framework.



30. Orakzai dialect research — linguistic framework.



31. Pashto + English — linguistic framework.



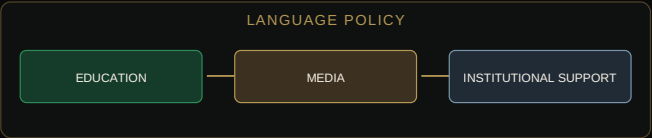
32. Pashto + Urdu — linguistic framework.



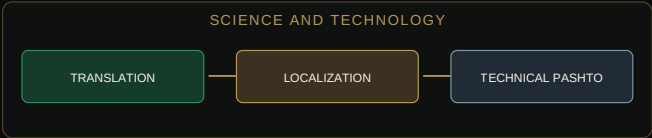
33. Afghanistan — linguistic framework.



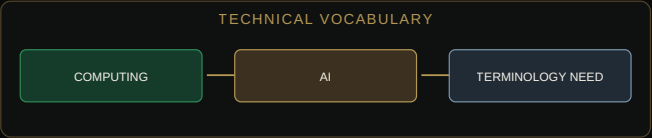
34. Pakistan — linguistic framework.



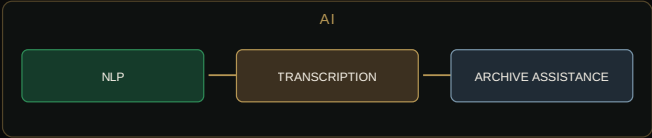
35. Language policy — linguistic framework.



36. Science and technology — linguistic framework.



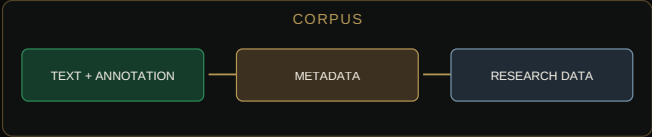
37. Technical vocabulary — linguistic framework.



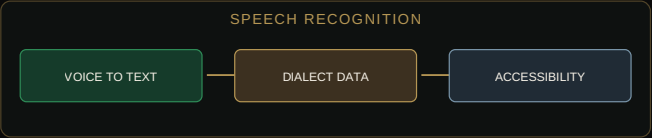
38. AI — linguistic framework.



39. Low-resource language — linguistic framework.



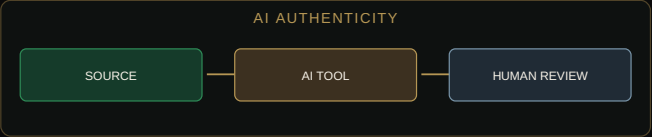
40. Corpus — linguistic framework.



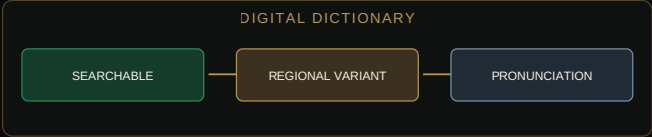
41. Speech recognition — linguistic framework.



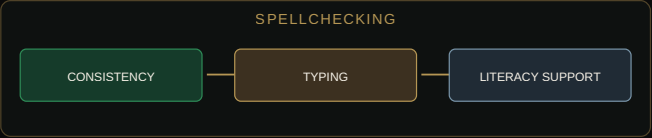
42. Machine translation — linguistic framework.



43. AI authenticity — linguistic framework.



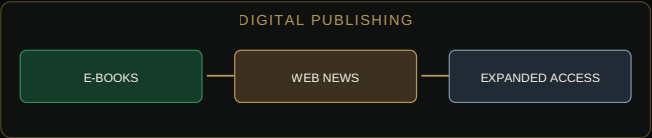
44. Digital dictionary — linguistic framework.



45. Spellchecking — linguistic framework.



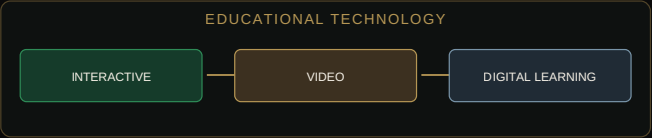
46. OCR — linguistic framework.



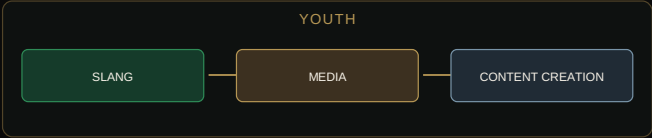
47. Digital publishing — linguistic framework.



48. Children — linguistic framework.



49. Educational technology — linguistic framework.



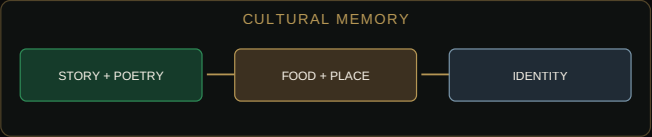
50. Youth — linguistic framework.



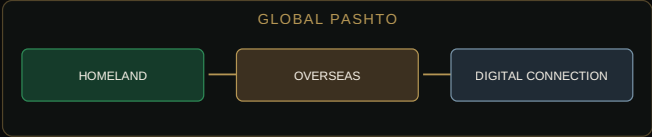
51. Women — linguistic framework.



52. Elders — linguistic framework.



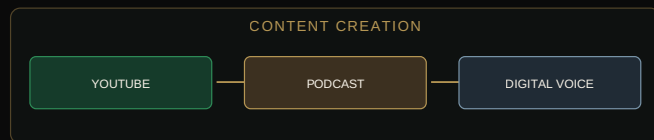
53. Cultural memory — linguistic framework.



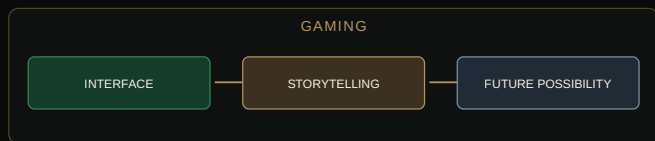
54. Global Pashto — linguistic framework.



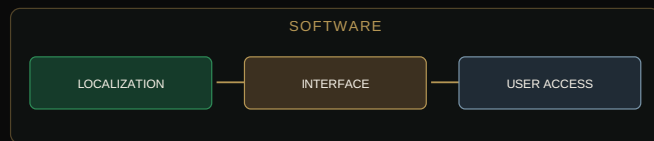
55. Internet — linguistic framework.



56. Content creation — linguistic framework.



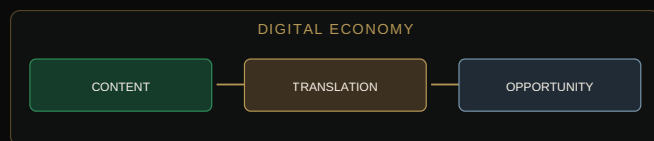
57. Gaming — linguistic framework.



58. Software — linguistic framework.



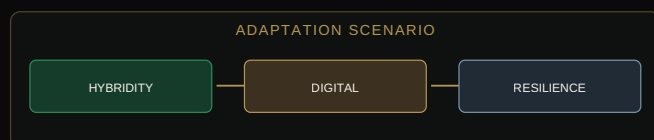
59. Accessibility — linguistic framework.



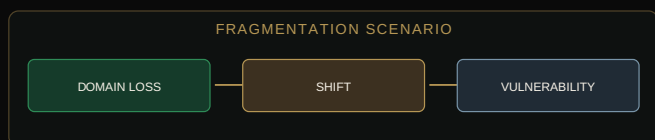
60. Digital economy — linguistic framework.



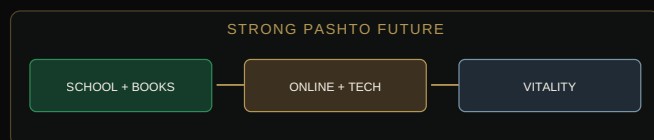
61. Continuity scenario — linguistic framework.



62. Adaptation scenario — linguistic framework.



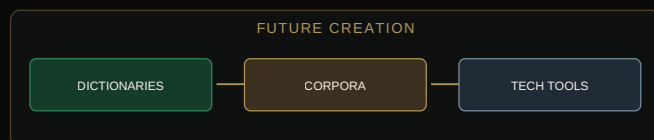
63. Fragmentation scenario — linguistic framework.



64. Strong Pashto future — linguistic framework.



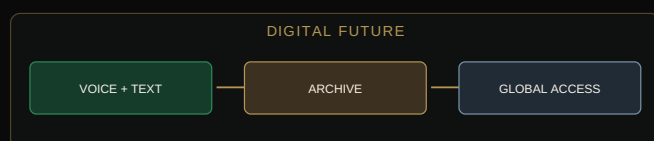
65. Preservation — linguistic framework.



66. Future creation — linguistic framework.



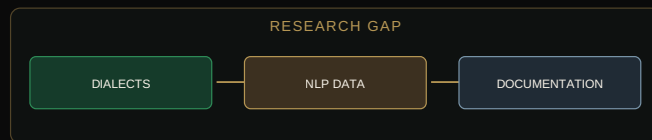
67. Ethical warnings — linguistic framework.



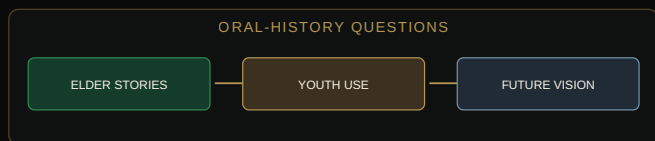
68. Digital future — linguistic framework.



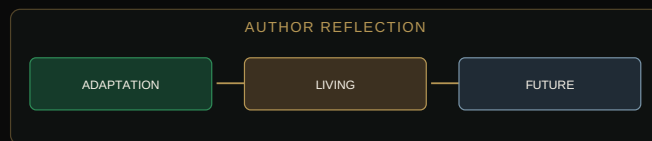
69. Orakzai future — linguistic framework.



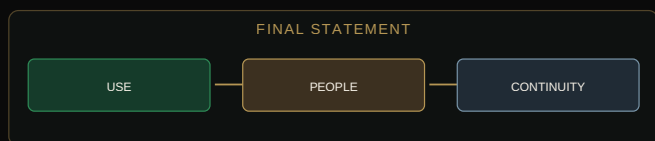
70. Research gap — linguistic framework.



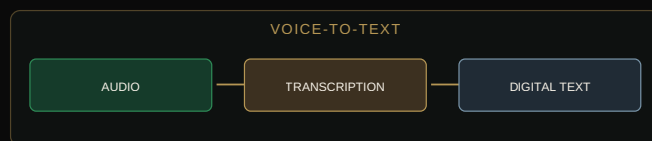
71. Oral-history questions — linguistic framework.



72. Author reflection — linguistic framework.



73. Final statement — linguistic framework.



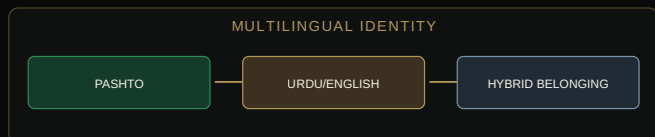
74. Voice-to-text — linguistic framework.



75. Pashto corpus — linguistic framework.



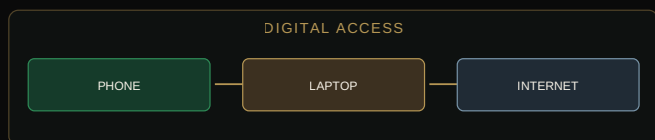
76. Language technology — linguistic framework.



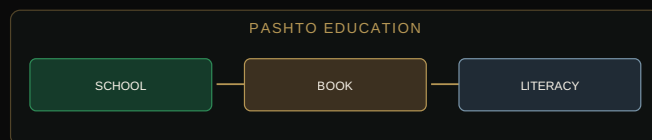
77. Multilingual identity — linguistic framework.



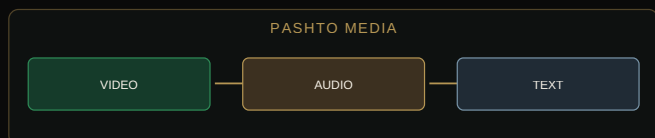
78. Future child — linguistic framework.



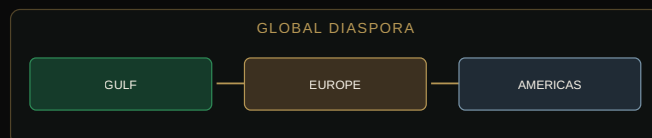
79. Digital access — linguistic framework.



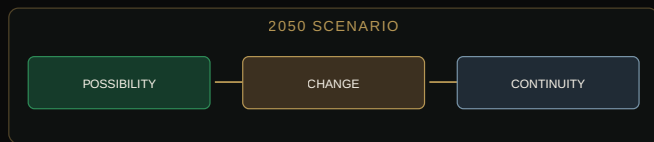
80. Pashto education — linguistic framework.



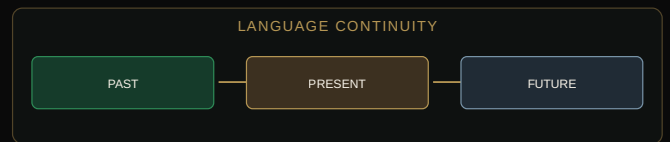
81. Pashto media — linguistic framework.



82. Global diaspora — linguistic framework.



83. 2050 scenario — linguistic framework.



84. Language continuity — linguistic framework.



85. Digital legacy — linguistic framework.

RESEARCH GAP: WHAT STILL NEEDS TO BE DOCUMENTED

- Orakzai-specific dialect research
- Village-level vocabulary
- Pronunciation variations
- Kinship terminology
- Agricultural vocabulary
- Place names
- Oral histories
- Children's language use
- Women's language experiences
- Urban Orakzai language use
- Diaspora language maintenance
- Pashto digital corpora
- Speech datasets
- OCR performance
- Machine-translation quality
- Digital dictionaries
- Educational resources
- Technical terminology
- Accessibility tools
- Social-media language change

ORAL HISTORY QUESTIONS

1. What Pashto words did your grandparents use that young people rarely use today?
2. Which words are unique to your village or region?
3. How did your family teach children Pashto?
4. Did migration change the language spoken at home?
5. Which Pashto books did you read?
6. Which poets influenced your family?
7. Which proverbs were commonly used?
8. Which stories were told to children?
9. How has social media changed Pashto writing?
10. Do young people mix Pashto with Urdu or English?
11. Which Pashto words should be documented?
12. What should schools teach in Pashto?
13. What Pashto content do children need?
14. What technology would make Pashto easier to use?
15. Which dialect differences should researchers document?
16. What should be preserved from today's Pashto?
17. What should change naturally?

18. What should never be fabricated? 20. What should Pashto look like in 2050?
19. How can diaspora families maintain Pashto?

AUTHOR'S REFLECTION

“I do not think the future of Pashto should be imagined as a choice between tradition and modernity. A language does not have to remain unchanged to remain itself. Pashto can live in a village and a city. It can live in a hujra and on a smartphone. It can live in poetry and in software. It can be spoken by an elder and learned by a child thousands of kilometres away.

The challenge is not to prevent change. Languages have always changed. The challenge is to make sure that change does not mean losing the ability to speak, write, create, remember and learn in Pashto. If the next generation can use Pashto to tell stories, study, create technology, make art, build businesses, communicate online and express its deepest memories, then the language is not merely surviving. It is living. And a living language can have a future.”

**THE FUTURE OF PASHTO WILL NOT BE
WRITTEN BY TECHNOLOGY ALONE.
IT WILL BE WRITTEN BY THE PEOPLE WHO
CONTINUE TO USE IT.**

RESEARCH SOURCES & FOOTNOTES

1. Khalid, A., et al., "Family language policy and identity formation among migrant Pashto community in Lahore," *HSS Comms*, 2026.
2. Haq, I., et al., "NLPashto: NLP Toolkit for Low-resource Pashto Language," *IJACSA*, 2023.
3. Ali, I., et al., "Monolingual Paraphrase Detection Corpus for Low Resource Pashto Language," *LREC-COLING*, 2024.
4. UNESCO, *Guidelines for the Preservation of Digital Heritage*, 2021.
5. Spolsky, B., *Language Policy*, Cambridge University Press, 2004.
6. Rahman, T., *Language and Politics in Pakistan*, Oxford University Press, 2006.